SHAME-01 | Therapist only - all age groups

Separating feelings, responsibility, and self-regard

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Explore a situation the person chooses without treating guilt or shame as proof of identity or responsibility. A need, boundary, or suitable repair step may be explored only if chosen and assessed as safe.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not hold a harmed person responsible for harm done to them, force confession, or require apology or renewed contact. Do not establish legal or moral facts through this sheet. Repair does not require contacting someone, forgiveness, or disclosure. Compulsive self-blame or OCD requires separate professional adaptation.

Reusing existing material

SELF-01 language may support self-regard. Here, focus on limited responsibility and choosing repair, without duplicating a thought diary or repeatedly proving that the person is good.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What situation will I choose to bring to the conversation?

2 | Question for discussion

What facts are known, and what conclusions come from the feeling?

3 | Question for discussion

What is my limited part, and what is not my responsibility?

4 | Question for discussion

What response to myself combines respect and realistic responsibility?

5 | Question for discussion

What need, boundary, or repair can be explored without harming me?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Discuss an action or situation, not a good or bad child. Do not place adult responsibility on a child.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Consider belonging and social exposure. Do not require public apology or showing private content.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Explore context and responsibility boundaries without promising moral certainty. Repeated guilt checking requires clinical consideration.

OA | Older adults

Respect life context and time. Do not prescribe settling old matters, renewing contact, or forgiveness as mandatory tasks.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Decide together whether practice between sessions is appropriate at all. Define one opportunity, boundaries, and desired support. Practice may take place only in the session. There is no required daily sequence or requirement to share the sheet with others.

At the next session

Check whether discussion increased distinction and choice or intensified blame and repeated checking. Do not measure success by guilt disappearing or receiving forgiveness.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.cci.health.wa.gov.au/Resources/Looking-After-Yourself/Self-Compassion

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